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20709

NATIONAL SECURITY COUNCIL

WASHINGTON, D.C. 20506

Summary of Conclusions for  
Meeting of the NSC Principals Committee

DATE: May 28, 1995

LOCATION: White House Situation Room

TIME: 1:00 - 3:00 p.m.

SUBJECT: Summary of Conclusions of Principals Committee Meeting  
on Bosnia ~~(S)~~

PARTICIPANTS:

Chair

Samuel Berger

USUN

Madeleine Albright

OVP

Leon Fuerth

CIA

William Studeman

State

Secretary Christopher

John Kornblum

Robert Frasure

JCS

General Shalikashvili

LTG Wesley Clark

DOD

Secretary Perry

Walter Slocombe

NSC

Alexander Vershbow

Colonel Nelson Drew

Summary of Conclusions

1. Principals met on May 28 to consider a range of policy options in light of the recent developments in Bosnia. They agreed on the following basic points for U.S. policy. (U)

2. **Prospects of additional airstrikes.** The U.S. will not press allies with troops on the ground for further strikes now, but: (a) the possibility of further strikes will not be ruled out; (b) should strikes again become necessary, a more robust approach permitting the UN and NATO to respond at the time and place of their own choosing should be followed rather than continuing to limit options on the basis of "strict proportionality" (**Action: JCS**); (c) privately we will accept a pause, but make no public statement to that effect; and (d) the Secretary of State will seek allied reactions to planning a substantial contingency strike option if Serb behavior, such as killing hostages, warranted a major attack (**Action: State**). ~~(S)~~

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3. **Diplomatic efforts at the UN and Contact Group.** We will:

(a) seek a formula with the French and UK on a sanctions reimposition mechanism based on an independent investigative panel and re-engage Milosevic on that basis to seek to conclude a Bosnian-Serb recognition package (**Action: State**); (b) press Milosevic in the context of such an agreement to push the Bosnian Serbs to release the hostages (**Action: State**); (c) explore the prospects for Russian assistance in control of Bosnian Serb heavy weapons (**Action: State**); and (d) renew efforts to gain UN condemnation of Bosnian Serb leadership as the principal obstacle to peace in the region based on recent events (**Action: State**). ~~(S)~~

4. **Options and prospects for emergency withdrawal.** Principals

noted: (a) no one is calling for withdrawal now, but that the situation could arise quickly; (b) NATO OPLAN 40104 would cover emergency withdrawal; (c) U.S. participation requires an immediate effort to complete consultations with Congress, starting with calls to key members and staff the following day (**Action: NSC**); and (d) non-NATO withdrawal using UK, French and U.S. assets was a possibility, but raised serious problems for NATO and for command and control of the operation (putting stress on the need to complete Congressional consultations on 40104). ~~(S)~~

5. **The future of UNPROFOR.** It was agreed that UNPROFOR

withdrawal from Bosnia under the present circumstances would be seen as capitulation to Bosnian-Serb blackmail and should be avoided. Instead, Principals agreed the U.S. strongly should support French efforts to enhance UNPROFOR's ability to perform its mandate by: (a) bolstering its capabilities (short of providing U.S. ground forces, but including provision of U.S. equipment if necessary -- including an offer of both U.S. airlift and equipment, if requested, to the British and French) (**Action: OSD**); (b) application of more robust ROE; and (c) "regrouping" UNPROFOR to reduce the risk. (Principals also agreed to a re-evaluation of the roles and missions of UNPROFOR to support future decisions on regrouping.) (**Action: JCS, OSD**). ~~(S)~~

6. **Assistance in UNPROFOR redeployment:** Principals agreed that, while the U.S. was not in favor of an UNPROFOR redeployment that pulled out from the eastern enclaves, U.S. credibility among NATO Allies would be seriously damaged if we were to turn down a request to NATO for assistance in relocating them from positions that had become untenable. It was agreed that the existing U.S. agreement in principle to provide ground troops as part of NATO led operations to assist UNPROFOR withdrawal should apply equally to an UNPROFOR request for assistance to NATO to relocate from positions that have become untenable to a safer area. They agreed that this decision required the approval of the President and consultations with Congress on this option. (**Action: NSC**) ~~(S)~~

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## **Clinton Presidential Records Mandatory Declassification Review**

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